ANDHRA PRADESH

D. PURANDESWARI
From: Congress to BJP in 2014
USP: Second daughter of TDP founder N.T. Rama Rao, she quit the Congress following the decision to reorganise Andhra Pradesh in 2014. She fought and lost the Lok Sabha polls on the party ticket for the Rajampet seat in 2014 and Visakhapatnam in 2019. Now she is among the 10 general secretaries—the lone woman—and steers the BJP Mahila Morcha

Y.S. CHOWDARY
From: TDP to BJP in 2019
USP: Following the rout of the TDP in the 2019 Lok Sabha and Andhra Pradesh assembly polls, four (all industrialists) of its six Rajya Sabha members led by Chowdary, a former Union Minister, joined the BJP. His tenure has ended

C.M. RAMESH
From: TDP to BJP in 2019
USP: He is among the four of six Rajya Sabha members who joined the BJP soon after the rout of the TDP in the 2019 Lok Sabha and Andhra Pradesh assembly polls. His tenure ends in April 2024



T.G. VENKATESH
From: TDP to BJP in 2019
USP: He is among the four of six Rajya Sabha members who joined the BJP soon after the rout of the TDP in the 2019 Lok Sabha and Andhra Pradesh assembly polls

TAMIL NADU

NAINAR NAGENDRAN
From: AIADMK to BJP in 2017
USP: One of the four MLAs of BJP, Nagendran is a former AIADMK minister. He is now vice-president of the Tamil Nadu BJP and is leader of the legislature party

KHUSHBU SUNDAR
From: Congress to BJP
USP: Actor turned politician was face of Congress in Tamil Nadu and national media. She now actively articulates BJP's point of view

P. SARAVANAN
From: DMK to BJP in March 2021
USP: Was sitting MLA of DMK from Tirupparankundram, he along with Ku Ka Selvam (MLA, Thousand Lights constituency) had joined BJP and contested on party's ticket but lost polls. Is active in state unit

PUDUCHERRY

A. NAMASSIVAYAM
From: Congress to BJP in January 2021
USP: Former state PCC chief and was minister in Narayanasamy government. He was first to join BJP and led the exodus of other legislators. Today he is home minister of the state



★ Chief Minister ★ Union minister

not standing up for him when the duo of Kamal Nath and Digvijay Singh, then chief minister and former CM, were gradually marginalising him in state politics, and he was denied a Rajya Sabha ticket. The BJP lost no time in dangling the alluring prospect of "appropriate honour, affection and apt position in decision-making", with an entry into the Upper House coming free with the offer. More to the point, when he walked out, he took with him 22 sitting Congress MLAs. The BJP leveraged that momentum to pull in six more to render the Nath government hors de combat.

A grand strike like this, ambitious in scope and execution, needs to be sure-footed and viable. Replacing a stable government with an unstable one will not do. Hence, the fact that the BJP won 19 of the seats vacated by Jyotiraditya's renegade MLAs in subsequent bypolls is not a mere footnote; ensuring that win is integral to the plot.

OLD-TIMERS RESENTING THE FACT THAT NEWBIES ARE GETTING PRIME POSTS ARE PACIFIED BY BJP LEADERS SAYING IT IS ALL BEING DONE FOR A LARGER CAUSE

It cemented Shivraj Singh Chouhan's grip on the throne. But everywhere, success crafted through these means also creates its own headaches, letting loose an all-new conflictual element on the picture-frame. In the last two decades of his dominance in Madhya Pradesh politics, Chouhan has never had to struggle like this to cope with surplus. Indeed, for the first 40 days of his rule, he had no ministers—and it took him almost four months to form his full cabinet. Even when he got himself one, it wasn't one of his choice—put it down to the exigency of having to accommodate the rebels who made his return to power possible. That's when he made his famously cryptic remark, "*Jab manthan hota hai, amrit nikalta hai, par vish Shiv ko grahan karna hota hai*" (When there is a churn, nectar is produced, but the by-product is poison, and Lord Shiva has to consume that)."

Before him, B.S. Yediyurappa had to consume the same "poison" in Karnataka. In July 2019, 13 legislators from the Janata Dal (Secular) and Congress succumbed to the saffron temptation and shifted loyalties. The H.D. Kumaraswamy government, running with the support of the Congress, started tottering. After three weeks of political drama, filled with the usual noise of media headlines and legal battles, the regime fell and BSY returned to the top